



CBHVs AGENTS OF CHANGE

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The Global Affairs Canada funded, Supporting Health Outcomes for Women & Children (SHOW) Project in Nigeria, in which Life Helpers is partnering with Plan International, is expected to contribute to the reduction of maternal and child mortality in Sokoto state, covering the entire 23 Local Government Areas. One of its immediate outcome is improved utilization of essential health services by women of child bearing age (WCBA), adolescent girls, new-born and children under 5 living in poverty.



Life Helpers Initiative is implementing this intervention in 7 LGAs namely Tureta, Shagari, Bodinga Yabo, Dange Shuni, Kware, and Rabah through capacity building, community mobilization, referrals and follow-up strategies. These strategies is strengthening by the critical engagement of Community Based Health Volunteers (CBHV). CBHVs are local women (who are either of active reproductive age or ceases child bearing) from the communities where this project is being implemented. The selected CBHV must be willing to participate, available for training and are ready to mobilize women to attend the Health Facilities and Hospitals in their localities in order to improve the level of Maternal Neonatal and Child Health (MNCH) /Sexual Reproductive Health (SRH).



They help inculcate key households and community-based Maternal Neonatal and Child Health (MNCH) as well as Sexual Reproductive Health (SRH) practices, including child spacing, nutrition, hygiene through the use of counseling cards with effective communication and negotiation skills. Also, adopting gender lens in every discussion, encouraging behavioral changes that improve MNCH, and SRH in their various communities.

The 770 CBHVs, who are all women, have been active for almost 3 years, since the commencement of the project and have achieved key milestones. Their roles have ensured that fellow women in their localities develop greater understanding of the need to access and use health services; worked to deepen the conversation that is



removing different layers of barriers; established open conversations with women and their husbands, other members of the family and the community at large on maternal, newborn, child health practices along with family planning and other reproductive health issues. More importantly, their roles have saved many lives of pregnant women and children including malnourished children through identification, referral and follow-ups.



Sustainably, their role guarantees the continuous use of counseling cards, effectively communicating key healthy behaviors among women and their families; continuously community advocacy for improved community system that supports required behavioral changes; provide residual local capacity for government and other implementing partner of relevant community-based health initiatives.

Lastly, these women have taken bold steps by participating in the collection of the necessary data on MNCH services, family planning etc at the community level and such data is transmitted appropriately to the State Ministry of Health through the Local Government Directorate of Health.

These women indeed have become change agents making strong impacts in their communities.



Staff Corner



Akogwu Joy

Position:

Director M&E

Educational Background:

Usmanu Danfodio University.
Accounting (B.Sc)

Marital Status: Married.

How long have you been working with LHI:
2013 till Date.

Hobbies: Reading, researching and meeting new friends.

Date of Birth: 25th Dec, 1986



LIFE HELPERS INITIATIVE

putting a smile on a face

www.lhinigeria.org



Mission

To be a leading regional non-governemental organisation empowering, children, youths, women and communities to live maximally in all aspect of life through advocacy, capacity development initiatives, community mobilization and socio-economic development.

Vision

A more fulfilled life for everyone.



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